

I cannot be there. It is too dangerous now — and the thing was never mine to keep. I was only ever to carry it a little of the way.

So now it falls to you. What you were to put into my hands, you will put into his: THE KOMTUR OF THE ORDER, ALBRECHT HIMSELF — into his own hand, and no other's. He holds this city for the Order, and to him the Order's word must go.

But know this: the Komtur trusts no one on sight, least of all in days like these. He will not take what you carry on your say-so. When you find him, NAME TO HIM WHAT HE BORE THROUGH THE TOWN THIS MORNING — that is the word we set for today, and by it he will know you came from me. And be ready to prove you are the Order's: he will ask it of you. Give him no cause to doubt.

Go carefully. — N.